🏡 Frequently Asked Questions: Buying Real Estate in BC

1️⃣ How much do I need for a down payment?

In Canada, the minimum down payment is **5%** for homes under $500K, **10%** for the portion between $500K-$999K, and **20%** for homes over $1M. First-time buyers may qualify for incentives to help!

2️⃣ What are the additional costs besides the purchase price?

Aside from the down payment, budget for **closing costs** like property transfer tax (PTT), legal fees, home inspection, appraisal, and potential GST on new builds.

3️⃣ How does the mortgage approval process work?

You'll need to get **pre-approved** first, which involves proving your income, credit score, and debt-to-income ratio. Lenders will assess your ability to handle payments based on the stress test.

4️⃣ What's the difference between freehold, leasehold, and strata properties?

- Freehold = You own the land and property (most houses).
- Leasehold = You lease the land (common with some Vancouver properties).
- Strata = You own your unit but share common areas & fees (condos/townhomes).

5️⃣ Do I really need a realtor to buy a home?

Technically, no—but a good realtor will help you find the right property, negotiate a great deal, navigate paperwork, and avoid costly mistakes. Plus, buyers don't pay commission—so why not have expert guidance for **FREE**?

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